Zenvara — Brand Identity & Marketing Research

A comprehensive branding, positioning, and go-to-market strategy document for the Zenvara platform, branded as **Zenvara**.

Selected from 830+ candidates across 12 phases of naming research (see `TAS-96_naming-research.md`). Zenvara scored highest on brand aesthetics, international pronounceability, etymological depth, and domain viability among all purchasable-tier candidates.

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1. Brand Identity Foundation

1.1 Name: Zenvara

Zen + **Vara** — two roots from different traditions, converging on the same idea: *clarity through truth*.

1.2 Etymology Deep Dive

Zen (□)

Layer	Detail
Japanese	□ (zen) — meditation, contemplative absorption
Chinese	□ (chán) — the school of Buddhism emphasizing direct insight
Sanskrit origin	□□□□□ (dhyāna) — meditation, profound contemplation
Core meaning	Direct perception without conceptual clutter. Seeing things as they are.
Cultural associations	Calm mastery, elegant simplicity, the art of doing one thing well, flow state, minimal but complete

Layer	Detail
In tech culture	"Zen mode" = focused, distraction-free. AMD Zen architecture = efficient design. Zendesk = calm customer service. The word carries instant recognition of clarity and discipline.

Zen does not mean "relaxed" or "simple." It means *seeing clearly* — cutting through noise to perceive what is actually happening. A Zen master is not passive; they are *precisely aware*.

Vara (□□)

Layer	Detail
Sanskrit	□□ (vara) — the choicest, the best, a boon or blessing; also truth, excellence
Old Norse	vara — awareness, vigilance, protection. "Taka vara á sér" = to be on guard, to be aware.
Spanish	vara — a measuring rod, a standard of measurement (from Latin *vāra*)
Core meaning	Truth, excellence, the chosen/measured standard
Cultural associations	Something earned through discipline. The best outcome, not by luck, but by design. Protection through awareness.

Vara carries weight across multiple language families — Sanskrit, Norse, and Romance — each contributing a facet: truth, awareness, and measured precision.

Combined: Zenvara

> **"Clarity through truth."**

The name encodes the system's philosophy:

- **Zen** = the clarity of direct execution, flow without friction, calm orchestration
- **Vara** = the truth of documentation, the protection of rollback, the awareness of self-introspection

Or, in the language of the system itself:

- **Zen** = the runtime (actors flowing, DAGs executing, expressions resolving)
- **Vara** = the knowledge layer (annotations, context.md, metadata.yaml, introspection, audit trails)

The two halves are not separate features — they are the same system observed from two perspectives, just as Zen practice and the insights it reveals are inseparable.

1.3 Pronunciation Guide

Notation	Value
Spoken	ZEN-vah-rah
IPA	/zɛnˈvɑːrə/
Syllables	3 (zen · va · ra)
Stress	Primary on first syllable, secondary on second

Cross-Language Pronunciation

Language	Natural reading	Matches?
English	ZEN-vah-rah	Yes — "zen" is a known word, "-vara" flows naturally
German	TSEN-vah-rah	Close — German "Z" = /ts/, but Zen is already a loanword pronounced /zɛn/ in German tech culture
French	ZEN-va-ʁa	Yes — flows naturally, no difficult consonant clusters
Spanish	THEN-ba-ra / SEN-ba-ra	Acceptable — Spanish speakers may use /θ/ or /s/ for Z, both work
Italian	DZEN-va-ra	Yes — Italian Z = /dz/, flows well
Japanese	ZEN-ba-ra	Close — familiar "zen" root, natural flow

No difficult consonant clusters. No sounds that don't exist in major European/Asian languages. The word flows in speech without requiring explanation.

1.4 Brand Voice

Zenvara's voice is **calm authority** — the confidence of a system that works and knows it works.

Voice Principles

Principle	Means	Does Not Mean
Direct over elaborate	"Zenvara runs 53 operators across 7 extension packs."	"Zenvara's innovative, cutting-edge operator ecosystem leverages synergistic..."
Show, don't claim	Show a YAML job that does something real in 12 lines.	"Our powerful platform enables digital transformation."
Respect reader intelligence	Assume the reader knows what a DAG is. Define terms only when genuinely uncommon.	Explaining what YAML is. Treating senior engineers like beginners.
No buzzword bingo	"AI operators run within the same pipeline discipline as every other step."	"AI-powered, cloud-native, enterprise-grade digital transformation synergy."
Calm, not boastful	"A single binary. No cluster. No JVM."	"We're the BEST orchestration platform EVER built!"
Precise numbers	"53 operators. 88 MCP tools. 88,000 lines of F#."	"Hundreds of features." "Countless integrations."
Earned confidence	"Rollback is designed in. Every write operator knows how to undo itself."	"We guarantee zero downtime."

Voice Examples

Bad (generic enterprise marketing):

> "Zenvara empowers organizations to unlock the full potential of their data through seamless, AI-driven orchestration that transforms how businesses operate in the digital age."

Good (Zenvara voice):

> "Define a pipeline in YAML. Zenvara compiles it, validates it, and runs it. If something breaks, it rolls back. Every step is documented. Every run is logged."

Bad (overselling):

> "The most powerful orchestration platform on the market, trusted by industry leaders worldwide."

Good (Zenvara voice):

> "53 operators. 88 MCP tools. One binary. No cluster required."

1.5 Visual Identity Direction

Color Palette

Role	Color	Hex	Rationale
Primary	Deep Indigo	`#1a1a3e`	Depth, trust, technical authority. The "Zen" dimension — deep calm.
Accent	Warm Amber/Saffron	`#f0a830`	Energy, truth, illumination. The "Vara" dimension — light breaking through. Saffron is the color of monks' robes in Buddhist and Hindu traditions, connecting to "zen" and "vara" etymologies.
Background	Stone Gray	`#e8e4df`	Neutrality, paper-like warmth, readability. Not sterile white — warm, organic.
Surface	Clean White	`#ffffff`	Cards, panels, code blocks — crisp and clear.
Text Primary	Near Black	`#1a1a2e`	Maximum readability against stone/white backgrounds.
Text Secondary	Warm Gray	`#6b6b7b`	Supporting text, labels, timestamps.
Success	Sage Green	`#4a9a6a`	Completed, healthy, validated.
Warning	Warm Coral	`#e86a50`	Attention needed, degraded state.
Error	Deep Red	`#c44040`	Failed, broken, needs action.

Color Philosophy

The indigo-amber pairing is deliberate: it echoes the contrast between deep meditation (indigo depths) and sudden insight (amber light). In data terms: the quiet background processing (indigo) and the moment results emerge (amber flash).

This avoids the two most overused enterprise palettes:

- **Not blue-and-white** (every SaaS company from Salesforce to Snowflake)

- **Not dark-mode-neon** (every developer tool from Vercel to Linear)

Zenvara's palette is warm, grounded, and distinctive — you'd recognize it in a lineup.

Typography

Role	Font	Rationale
Headings	Inter or Outfit	Clean geometric sans-serif. Modern, readable at all sizes. No decorative flourishes — the "Zen" principle of essential form.
Body	Inter	Optimized for screen reading. Extensive language support (Latin, Cyrillic, Greek).
Code	JetBrains Mono	The developer standard. Ligatures for operators (`=>` , `->` , `!=`). Distinguishes `0/O` , `1/l/I` .
Accent/Tagline	Outfit Light	Slightly more character than Inter for hero sections and pull quotes.

Logo Direction

The Zenvara mark should express **convergence** — multiple streams meeting at a calm center.

Concept: Geometric Convergence

Three or four paths (representing data streams, operators, pipelines) converging at a single point, forming a stable geometric shape. The paths are the "activity" (zen = flow), the center point is the "truth" (vara = what remains when noise is removed).

Visual properties:

- **Geometric, not organic** — precision, not approximation
- **Minimal line count** — 3-5 strokes maximum. Every line serves a purpose.
- **DAG echoes** — the paths suggest directed graph edges without being literally a graph diagram
- **Calm center** — the convergence point is a moment of stillness
- **Works at 16px** — favicon-viable. No fine detail that breaks at small sizes.
- **Single color viable** — the mark works in solid indigo, solid white, or solid black

What the logo is **not**:

- Not a globe or sphere (generic)
- Not a gear or cog (mechanical, dated)
- Not interconnected circles (every "integration" company uses this)
- Not an abstract swoosh (1990s corporate)
- Not a literal Zen circle (ensō) — too on-the-nose

Iconography Style

Feature icons follow the same geometric convergence language:

- **Line-based** — consistent 2px stroke weight
- **Indigo primary, amber for emphasis** — one highlight element per icon
- **Square grid** — all icons on a 24x24 grid
- **Rounded corners** — 2px radius, suggesting approachability without softness

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2. Product-Brand Alignment

2.1 The Zen-Vara Mapping

Every major feature of the platform maps naturally to one of the two brand dimensions. This is not forced — the naming research identified Zenvara precisely *because* the product already has this duality built in.

Zen Dimension: Clarity, Flow, Simplicity

The Zen dimension encompasses everything about *how the system runs* — execution, composition, expression, progression.

Feature	Technical Reality	Brand Language
Actor-based execution (Akka.NET)	Each job gets its own actor. Actors process messages sequentially, isolated from each other. No shared mutable state.	"*Each actor knows its role. The system flows.*"
DAG execution engine	Jobs are directed acyclic graphs — steps execute in dependency order, never in circles. The compiler enforces this before a single step runs.	"*Pipelines that cannot loop. Progress, by design.*"
Expression engine (FParsec)	A real parser-combinator expression language: arithmetic, comparison, logical operators, ternary expressions, 16 built-in functions. Not string interpolation — actual parsed, typed expressions.	"*Say exactly what you mean. The engine understands.*"
Value resolution system	`${path}` preserves type when used as an entire value, stringifies when embedded in a string. `${= expr}` evaluates expressions. Three distinct resolution modes, each with clear semantics.	"*References that know whether you need a value or a string.*"
YAML-to-AST compiler	Job YAML is not interpreted — it is compiled to an Abstract Syntax Tree, validated, and only then executed. Schema errors caught before runtime.	"*Clarity enforced before execution.*"
ForEach with sandboxing	Loop iterations cannot modify outer payload. Each iteration gets a clean scope with `index` (1-based) and `count`.	"*Loops that cannot leak. Each iteration, a clean room.*"
Conditional execution (when/if)	Steps can declare `when:` guards (plain expression syntax). `if/then/else` blocks for branching. `halt` for stopping. All compile-time validated.	"*Pipelines that think before they act.*"
Staging and deployment	Changes go to a staging overlay first. `staging diff` shows exactly what will change. `deploy` promotes to production. No surprises.	"*Deploy with certainty. See the diff before it lands.*"
Single-binary deployment	The entire system — all 53 operators, the MCP server, the REST API, the actor system, the expression engine — ships as one self-contained binary. No JVM, no cluster, no cloud dependency.	"*One binary. Nothing else to install.*"

Feature	Technical Reality	Brand Language
Cron scheduling	Jobs schedule via standard cron expressions. The scheduler actor checks every hour. Simple, predictable, no external scheduler needed.	"*Scheduling that just works. No external dependency.*"
`let:` bindings	Computed variables evaluated once at job start. Clean, declarative, no side effects.	"*Define once. Reference everywhere.*"
Human-in-the-loop	The `human-task` operator pauses execution and waits for human approval before continuing. The pipeline flows, then pauses, then flows again.	"*Sometimes the wisest action is to wait.*"
Pipeline composition	Payload accumulates as operations execute. Each step receives all prior results and adds its own. Pure functional composition: `Payload -> Async<Result<Payload, AppError>>`.	"*Each step builds on the last. Nothing lost.*"

Vara Dimension: Truth, Protection, Awareness

The Vara dimension encompasses everything about *what the system knows* — documentation, introspection, security, recoverability.

Feature	Technical Reality	Brand Language
Self-introspection	The system captures every MCP tool call — successes, errors, patterns, frequency. It can analyze its own usage and surface mistakes.	"*A system that knows itself.*"
Annotation system	Every entity — job, operator, environment, run, step — can carry tags, notes (info/warning/todo/changelog), and descriptions. Knowledge lives alongside process.	"*Truth lives alongside process.*"
Context documentation	Jobs, environments, and scripts each have `context.md` — living documentation that travels with the entity, not in a separate wiki.	"*Documentation that lives where the code lives.*"
Operator metadata	Every operator declares its inputs, outputs, config requirements, rollback capabilities, and actions in a `metadata.yaml` — machine-readable, auto-validated.	"*Every operator documents itself.*"
MCP server (88 tools)	The system exposes itself as an MCP server with 88 tools — AI agents can discover, execute, manage, and reason about the entire platform.	"*A system AI agents can understand.*"
Rollback/compensation	Write operators declare their own rollback logic. If a step fails, prior write steps can undo themselves. Recovery is designed in, not bolted on.	"*Protection designed in. Every write knows its undo.*"

Feature	Technical Reality	Brand Language
Secrets management	AES-256-GCM encrypted file storage or HashiCorp Vault integration. Path-based access policies. Secrets pre-resolved before execution — never logged, never in plaintext at rest.	"*Secrets handled, never exposed. Protected by policy.*"
Audit trail	Every run produces structured logs, status tracking, and output artifacts. Stored in `runs/{jobName}/{jobId}/` . Ulid-based IDs encode timestamps.	"*Every run tells its full story.*"
Role-based access control	Four roles (admin, developer, operator, viewer) with granular permissions. Five authentication providers (Local, API Key, LDAP, OIDC, Windows).	"*Access earned, not assumed.*"
State persistence	`SetState` / `GetState` persist data between runs as JSON. `Diff` compares current state against previous state. The system remembers.	"*A system that remembers what happened last time.*"
Script extensions (Python/PowerShell)	Python and PowerShell scripts become first-class operators with auto-generated type stubs, input/output validation, and full metadata integration.	"*Your scripts become first-class operators.*"
Multi-interface access	REST API, MCP server, and Swagger — three ways to interact with the same system. Each interface is complete, not a subset.	"*One system, three interfaces. Choose your language.*"
Operator registry	Operators discovered at startup via `[<OperatorFactory>]` attribute. No hardcoded list. Add an operator = drop a DLL.	"*Extensibility without modification.*"
Environment configuration	Service credentials stored in environment YAML files with typed config sections. Config validated against operator metadata at load time.	"*Configuration that validates itself.*"
Connection pooling	SFTP connections pooled and cleaned up automatically. HTTP clients managed by `IHttpClientFactory` . Resources managed, not leaked.	"*Resources managed, not wasted.*"
Package system	Jobs and environments can be exported as ZIP packages, imported, and deployed via CI/CD REST API. Portable, versionable units.	"*Pipelines you can ship.*"

2.2 The Duality in Practice

The Zen and Vara dimensions are not separate modules — they are two views of the same architecture. Consider a single job execution:

```
1. Job YAML is loaded          → Vara: metadata, context, annotations exist
2. YAML is compiled to AST     → Zen: clarity enforced before execution
3. Secrets are pre-resolved     → Vara: protection applied upfront
4. Actor spawns, begins flow   → Zen: calm orchestration begins
5. Each step executes          → Zen: payload flows, expressions resolve
6. Each step is logged         → Vara: truth captured in real-time
7. Introspection records call  → Vara: self-awareness of the execution
8. If failure: rollback fires  → Vara: protection activates
9. If success: output stored   → Zen: the pipeline completes its flow
10. Run artifacts preserved    → Vara: the truth of what happened, forever
```

This is why the name works: the product *is* the unity of flow and truth, execution and knowledge.

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3. Taglines

3.1 Candidates by Positioning Angle

Clarity / Simplicity (the Zen dimension)

#	Tagline	Notes
1	**Orchestration, clarified.**	Two words. Period. The confidence of brevity.
2	**Complexity resolved.**	"Resolved" works both as "solved" and as "expression resolution" (a core feature).
3	**Clarity in motion.**	The Zen principle applied to data movement.
4	**Pipelines that flow.**	Direct, unpretentious. Says what it does.
5	**Define. Compile. Execute.**	The actual lifecycle: YAML → AST → Run.

Truth / Documentation (the Vara dimension)

#	Tagline	Notes
6	**Where process and truth align.**	The core brand promise. Process (execution) and truth (documentation) are the same thing.
7	**Every process tells its story.**	Annotations, context, logs, introspection — processes are self-documenting.
8	**Process that knows itself.**	Self-introspection as a headline feature.
9	**Truth, built in.**	Documentation-as-architecture, not an afterthought.
10	**The system that remembers.**	State persistence, audit trails, introspection.

AI-Native

#	Tagline	Notes
11	**AI-native orchestration for the post-manual era.**	Positions Zenvara as the first orchestration platform built for AI agents.
12	**Where AI meets discipline.**	AI operators run within the same pipeline discipline — expressions, validation, rollback. Not a separate AI bolt-on.
13	**Orchestration that AI agents understand.**	The MCP server makes the system legible to AI. 88 tools exposed.
14	**Three LLMs. One pipeline.**	Claude, ChatGPT, Gemini — all as first-class operators in the same DAG.
15	**AI within the discipline.**	AI is not special in Zenvara — it follows the same rules as every other operator.

Power / Density

#	Tagline	Notes
16	**53 operators. 88 MCP tools. One calm system.**	Specific numbers (verified from codebase). The word "calm" is the brand signature.
17	**Enterprise orchestration in a single binary.**	The deployment story in seven words.
18	**88,000 lines of F#. No cluster required.**	Code density as a competitive advantage.
19	**More signal. Less infrastructure.**	Zenvara vs. NiFi cluster, ADF cloud, MuleSoft runtime.
20	**The density of F#, applied.**	For the technical audience that appreciates functional programming.

Developer-First

#	Tagline	Notes
21	**YAML in. Results out.**	The developer experience in four words.
22	**Write YAML. Ship pipelines. Sleep well.**	Confidence + simplicity + the rollback safety net.
23	**Pipelines as code. Actually.**	A dig at platforms that claim "infrastructure as code" but require a GUI to configure.
24	**Your expression engine awaits.**	For developers tired of limited template languages.
25	**The orchestration tool you'd build yourself.**	Implies: if you had the time and F# expertise, you'd arrive at this design.

Enterprise Trust

#	Tagline	Notes
26	**Orchestration you can reason about.**	Compile-time validation, typed expressions, DAG guarantees — no mystery.
27	**From staging to production, with certainty.**	The staging/deployment workflow.
28	**Deploy what you inspected.**	Staging diff → deploy. WYSIWYG for pipelines.
29	**The orchestration layer that audits itself.**	Introspection + logging + state tracking.
30	**Built for the team that reads the logs.**	For ops teams that value observability.

Philosophical (the Zen dimension, elevated)

#	Tagline	Notes
31	**The mastery of orchestrated flow.**	"Mastery" echoes Zen mastery. "Flow" echoes both data flow and flow state.
32	**Excellence, observed.**	"Vara" = excellence. "Observed" = introspection. Three syllables total.
33	**Clarity through truth.**	The literal meaning of the name. Could serve as a subtle subtitle.
34	**Calm systems run deep.**	A twist on "still waters run deep."
35	**Order, not complexity.**	What Zenvara adds: structure. What it removes: chaos.

3.2 Tagline Evaluation Matrix

Scored 1-5 across four dimensions. Total out of 20.

#	Tagline	Memorability	Differentiation	Enterprise Appeal	Developer Appeal	Total
1	Orchestration, clarified.	5	4	5	3	17
6	Where process and truth align.	4	5	5	3	17
16	53 operators. 88 MCP tools. One calm system.	5	5	4	4	18
17	Enterprise orchestration in a single binary.	4	5	5	4	18

#	Tagline	Memorability	Differentiation	Enterprise Appeal	Developer Appeal	Total
21	YAML in. Results out.	5	3	2	5	15
22	Write YAML. Ship pipelines. Sleep well.	5	4	3	5	17
11	AI-native orchestration for the post-manual era.	4	5	5	3	17
26	Orchestration you can reason about.	4	5	5	5	19
33	Clarity through truth.	5	5	4	3	17
8	Process that knows itself.	5	5	4	4	18

3.3 Recommended Tagline Combinations

Primary tagline (hero section, main positioning):

> **Orchestration you can reason about.**

Why: highest total score. Appeals to both enterprises (trust, predictability) and developers (transparency, no magic). Differentiates from every competitor that asks you to trust black-box execution.

Secondary tagline (subtitle, below the logo):

> **Clarity through truth.**

Why: the literal meaning of the name. Concise, philosophical, unique. Works as a persistent brand tagline alongside the primary.

Marketing tagline (landing page hero, ads):

> **53 operators. 88 MCP tools. One calm system.**

Why: specific numbers command attention. "Calm" is the brand word — no competitor uses it. Differentiates through density and composure.

Developer tagline (docs, GitHub, CLI):

> **Write YAML. Ship pipelines. Sleep well.**

Why: speaks directly to the developer experience. The three-beat rhythm is memorable. "Sleep well" implies safety (rollback, validation).

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4. Website Design Direction

4.1 Page Structure

Page	Purpose	Priority
Home	Hero + feature overview + comparison + CTA	Launch (1.0)
Features	Detailed feature breakdown by category (operators, AI, security, etc.)	Launch (1.0)
Docs	Technical documentation, guides, API reference	Launch (1.0)
Pricing	Tier comparison, calculator, FAQ	Launch (1.0)
Blog	Technical articles, release notes, case studies	Launch (1.0)
Community	Discord/GitHub links, contribution guide	Launch (1.0)
Marketplace	Extension packages, community scripts	2.0
Studio	Web UI demo / access	2.0

4.2 Landing Page Layout

Hero Section

```
┌──────────────────────────────────────────────────────────┐
│                                                          │
│  [Zenvara Logo]                                          │
│                                                          │
│          Orchestration you can reason about.             │
│                                                          │
│     53 operators. 88 MCP tools. One calm system.         │
│                                                          │
│  ┌──────────────┐  ┌─────────────────┐                  │
│  │  Get Started  │  │  View on GitHub  │                 │
│  └──────────────┘  └─────────────────┘                   │
│                                                          │
│          ┌──────────────────────────┐                    │
│          │  ▒▒ Animated DAG visual ▒▒  │                 │
│          │  ▒▒ Nodes lighting up as  ▒▒│                 │
│          │  ▒▒ data flows through    ▒▒│                 │
│          └──────────────────────────┘                    │
│                                                          │
└──────────────────────────────────────────────────────────┘
```

The animated DAG visualization shows:

- Nodes appearing one by one (representing operators)
- Amber pulses flowing along edges (representing data)
- Nodes changing from indigo to amber as they complete
- The final node emitting a calm amber glow (output ready)

The animation is subtle, not flashy — steady, purposeful movement. It runs once, then holds its completed state. No infinite loops.

Feature Cards Section

```
┌──────────────────────────────────────────────────────────┐
│                                                          │
│   ┌──────────────┐  ┌──────────────┐  ┌──────────────┐  │
│   │ ◇ Compose    │  │ ◆ Observe    │  │ ◇ Resolve    │  │
│   │              │  │              │  │              │  │
│   │ YAML-defined │  │ Introspect   │  │ Expressions  │  │
│   │ DAG pipeline │  │ every tool   │  │ that preserve│  │
│   │ execution.   │  │ call. Know   │  │ type. 16     │  │
│   │ 53 operators │  │ your system. │  │ built-in     │  │
│   │ across 7     │  │              │  │ functions.   │  │
│   │ categories.  │  │              │  │              │  │
│   └──────────────┘  └──────────────┘  └──────────────┘  │
│                                                          │
│   ┌──────────────┐  ┌──────────────┐  ┌──────────────┐  │
│   │ ◆ Protect    │  │ ◇ Flow       │  │ ◆ Extend     │  │
│   │              │  │              │  │              │  │
│   │ AES-256-GCM  │  │ Actor-based  │  │ Python and   │  │
│   │ secrets.     │  │ concurrency. │  │ PowerShell   │  │
│   │ Rollback on  │  │ One binary.  │  │ scripts as   │  │
│   │ every write. │  │ No cluster.  │  │ first-class  │  │
│   │ RBAC + LDAP. │  │ No JVM.      │  │ operators.   │  │
│   └──────────────┘  └──────────────┘  └──────────────┘  │
│                                                          │
│   ◇ = Zen dimension    ◆ = Vara dimension                │
│                                                          │
└──────────────────────────────────────────────────────────┘
```

Feature cards use the brand vocabulary:

- **Compose** = DAG building (Zen)
- **Observe** = introspection (Vara)
- **Resolve** = expression engine (Zen)
- **Protect** = secrets + rollback (Vara)
- **Flow** = actor execution (Zen)
- **Extend** = scripts + registry (Vara)

Code Showcase Section

```
┌──────────────────────────────────────────────────────────┐
│                                                          │
│   See it in action                                       │
│                                                          │
│   ┌──────────────────────────┐  ┌──────────────────────────┐ │
│   │ job.yaml                 │  │ Result                   │ │
│   │                          │  │                          │ │
│   │ version: "1.0.0"         │  │ {                        │ │
│   │ name: daily-report       │  │   "status": "completed",│ │
│   │ schedule: "0 9 * * *"    │  │   "steps": 4,           | |
│   │ steps:                   │  │   "duration": "2.3s",    | |
│   │   - as: data             │  │   "output": {            | |
│   │     type: http           │  │     "records": 1247,     | |
│   │     action: get          │  │     "report": "s3://..."| |
│   │     input:               │  │   }                      | |
│   │       Url: "..."         │  | }                        | |
│   │   - as: transform        │  |                          | |
│   │     type: csv-to-json    │  |                          | |
│   │     input:               |  |                          | |
│   │       Data: ${data}      |  |                          | |
│   │   - as: report           |  |                          | |
│   │     type: template       |  |                          | |
│   │     input:               |  |                          | |
│   │       Template: "..."    |  |                          | |
│   │   - as: send             |  |                          | |
│   │     type: email          |  |                          | |
│   │     input:               |  |                          | |
│   │       To: "team@..."     |  |                          | |
│   │       Subject: "Daily"   |  |                          | |
│   │       Body: ${report}    |  |                          | |
│   └──────────────────────────┘  └──────────────────────────┘ │
│                                                          │
│   4 steps. HTTP → CSV → Template → Email.                │
│   Defined in YAML. Compiled. Executed. Done.             │
│                                                          │
└──────────────────────────────────────────────────────────┘
```

Comparison Table Section

```
┌──────────────────────────────────────────────────────────┐
│                                                          │
│   How Zenvara compares                                   │
│                                                          │
│   ┌──────────────┬────────┬──────┬──────┬──────┬──────┐  │
│   | Feature      |Zenvara | NiFi | ADF  |Mule  |Airfl.|  |
│   |──────────────|────────|──────|──────|──────|──────|  |
│   | Deployment   |1 binary|Cluster|Cloud |Runtime|Cluster| |
│   | AI-native    |  Yes   |  No  |Add-on|  No  |  No  |  |
│   | MCP server   |  Yes   |  No  |  No  |  No  |  No  |  |
│   | Self-intro.  |  Yes   |  No  |  No  |  No  |  No  |  |
│   | Expression   |Custom  | NiFi | ADF  |DWeave|Jinja |  |
│   |   engine     |(typed) |  EL  | expr |      |      |  |
│   | YAML-to-AST  |  Yes   |  No  |  No  |  No  |  No  |  |
│   | Rollback     |Built-in|  No  |  No  |  No  |  No  |  |
│   | Auth/RBAC    | Full   | Full |Azure | Full | Full |  |
│   | Visual UI    |  2.0   | Yes  | Yes  | Yes  | Yes  |  |
│   | Clustering   |  No    | Yes  | Yes  | Yes  | Yes  |  |
│   └──────────────┴────────┴──────┴──────┴──────┴──────┘  |
│                                                          |
└──────────────────────────────────────────────────────────┘
```

Live Metrics Badge

A subtle, real-time badge in the hero or nav area:

```
┌──────────────────────────────────────┐
│ ● 53 operators │ 88 MCP tools │ v1.x │
└──────────────────────────────────────┘
```

These numbers can be fetched from the running instance's MCP server (operator count, tool count, version) — making the website itself a demonstration of Zenvara's capabilities.

4.3 Hero Concepts

Concept A: "The Convergence"

```
┌──────────────────────────────────────────────────┐
│                                                  │
│                   Z E N V A R A                   │
│                                                  │
│        Orchestration you can reason about.        │
│                                                  │
│             /─── ○ http                           │
│            /                                      │
│     ○ ───○──────── ○ transform ───○ output        │
│            \                                      │
│             \─── ○ sftp                           │
│                                                  │
│  Data flows. Operators compose. Truth is preserved.  │
│                                                  │
│  [ Get Started ]  [ Documentation ]               │
│                                                  │
└──────────────────────────────────────────────────┘
```

Animated: nodes pulse amber left-to-right as "data flows through."

Concept B: "The Calm Center"

```
┌──────────────────────────────────────────────────┐
│                                                  │
│                   Z E N V A R A                   │
│                                                  │
│        Orchestration you can reason about.        │
│                                                  │
│             http ──\                              │
│                     \                             │
│             sftp ────── ◉ ────── output           │
│                     /        (amber glow)         │
│           claude ──/                              │
│                                                  │
│      Multiple sources. One calm orchestrator.     │
│                                                  │
│  [ Get Started ]  [ View Source ]                   │
│                                                  │
└──────────────────────────────────────────────────┘
```

The center node (◉) has a subtle amber glow — the "calm center" where all streams converge. Animated: streams flow inward, center glows steadily.

Concept C: "The Pipeline"

```
┌──────────────────────────────────────────────────────┐
│                                                      │
│                   Z E N V A R A                      |
│                                                      |
│         Write YAML. Ship pipelines. Sleep well.      |
│                                                      |
│   ┌──────┐   ┌──────┐   ┌──────┐   ┌──────┐         |
│   |  GET | → |PARSE | → | AI   | → | SEND |         |
│   |      |   |      |   |      |   |      |         |
│   | http |   | csv  |   |claude|   |email |         |
│   └──────┘   └──────┘   └──────┘   └──────┘         |
│   ═══════════════════════════════════                  |
│         ▒▒▒▒▒▒▒▒▒▒▒▒▒▒▒▒▒▒▒▒▒▒▒▒ (progress)            |
│                                                      |
│  [ Get Started ]  [ See Examples ]                    |
│                                                      |
└──────────────────────────────────────────────────────┘
```

The most literal concept. Animated: progress bar fills left-to-right, each box lights up amber as the pipeline step completes. Simple, clear, developer-oriented.

Recommended: Concept B ("The Calm Center") for the primary hero — it best expresses the brand identity (convergence, calm mastery, multiple sources into unified output). Concept C for the "Features" page hero — more literal and developer-oriented.

4.4 Responsive Design Approach

Mobile-first design:

- Hero: tagline + single CTA, DAG visual as a horizontal scrollable card
- Feature cards: single-column stack, swipeable
- Code showcase: tabbed (YAML | Result), horizontal scroll for code
- Comparison table: card-based (one competitor per card, swipe to compare)
- Navigation: hamburger menu with full-screen overlay (indigo background, amber highlights)

Breakpoints:

Breakpoint	Layout
< 640px	Single column, stacked cards, tabbed code
640-1024px	2-column feature cards, side-by-side code
> 1024px	3-column feature cards, full comparison table

---

5. Value Propositions by Audience

5.1 CTO / VP Engineering

Core message: "Reduce integration complexity. Replace cluster infrastructure with a single binary."

Pain Point	Zenvara Solution
"We have NiFi/MuleSoft clusters that require dedicated DevOps"	Single self-contained binary. Deploy via systemd or Docker. No cluster management.
"Our integration platform doesn't work with AI"	Three LLM providers (Claude, ChatGPT, Gemini) as first-class operators. AI agents interact via 88 MCP tools.
"We can't see what our pipelines are doing"	Self-introspection captures every tool call. Annotations document every entity. Context travels with the pipeline.
"Our integration platform costs $500K/year"	Open-core model. Professional tier is a fraction of MuleSoft/ADF pricing. On-prem or cloud.
"We need DACH compliance (data sovereignty)"	On-premise deployment. AES-256-GCM secrets. Path-based access policies. No data leaves your network.

One-liner: "Enterprise orchestration without the enterprise infrastructure."

5.2 DevOps / Platform Engineering

Core message: "Deploy in 5 minutes. Monitor via standard tools. No JVM tuning."

Pain Point	Zenvara Solution
"NiFi takes 2 days to set up properly"	`wget`, `chmod +x`, `systemctl start`. Single binary, single config file.
"Our platform doesn't have a CI/CD API"	Full CI/CD REST API: validate, deploy, package, execute. Integrate with any pipeline.
"Configuration drift between environments"	Staging overlay with diff. See exactly what changes before promoting to production.
"Secret rotation is manual and risky"	HashiCorp Vault integration or encrypted file storage. Policy-based access. Hot-reload on change.
"Monitoring requires custom dashboards"	Structured logs via Serilog. Introspection endpoint. Standard observability patterns.

One-liner: "Self-contained. No JVM. Deploy via systemd or Docker. CI/CD REST API included."

5.3 Software Developer

Core message: "A real expression engine. Type-preserving references. Extensibility in Python or PowerShell."

Pain Point	Zenvara Solution
"Template languages are too limited"	Full expression engine: arithmetic, comparison, logical, ternary, 16 built-in functions. Parsed by FParsec, not regex.
"References lose type information"	`${path}` preserves type when used as an entire value. String interpolation only when embedded in text.
"I can't extend the platform without Java/Scala"	Write a Python or PowerShell script. It becomes a first-class operator with auto-generated type stubs.

Pain Point	Zenvara Solution
"YAML-based tools have no validation"	YAML is compiled to an AST. Schema errors caught before runtime. Expression syntax validated at compile time.
"AI integration is always a separate system"	`type: claude`, `type: chatgpt`, `type: gemini` — AI operators in the same pipeline as HTTP, SFTP, SQL. Same `${step.result}` pattern.

One-liner: "Define pipelines in YAML with a real expression engine. Extend in Python. Deploy as one binary."

5.4 Security / Compliance Officer

Core message: "Encrypted secrets. Policy-based access. Full audit trail. On-prem deployment."

Pain Point	Zenvara Solution
"Secrets in plaintext config files"	AES-256-GCM encrypted file storage. Secrets pre-resolved at job start — never in logs, never in plaintext at rest.
"No access control granularity"	Path-based secrets policies. Role-based access (admin/developer/operator/viewer). Five auth providers (including LDAP and OIDC).
"Cloud-only platforms violate data sovereignty"	Full on-premise deployment. Single binary. Data never leaves your network.
"No audit trail for pipeline executions"	Every run: structured logs, status tracking, output artifacts. Ulid-based IDs encode timestamps. Introspection captures every MCP tool call.
"We can't prove what ran in production"	Staging → diff → deploy workflow. Immutable run artifacts. State persistence with diff comparison.

One-liner: "AES-256-GCM secrets. Policy-based ACL. Full audit trail. Data stays on your infrastructure."

5.5 Data Engineer

Core message: "ETL/ELT pipelines in YAML. CSV, JSON, SQL, S3, SFTP — all as operators."

Pain Point	Zenvara Solution
"Our ETL tool doesn't support modern formats"	CSV-to-JSON, JSON-extract, XSLT, batch-json, csv-transform, csv-load — 7 converter operators.
"Moving data between S3/SFTP/SQL is too many tools"	S3, SFTP, Filesystem, HTTP, MSSQL, Redshift — all first-class operators in the same pipeline.
"We need conditional logic in our pipelines"	`if/then/else`, `when:` guards, `ForEach` loops, `halt` — full control flow in YAML.
"State between runs is manual"	`SetState` / `GetState` persist JSON between runs. `Diff` compares current against previous. Automated change detection.
"Our Airflow DAGs are Python — not everyone can write Python"	Zenvara DAGs are YAML. Readable by anyone. Expression engine handles the logic.

One-liner: "S3 to SQL to email — in one YAML file. State remembered between runs."

6. Competitive Positioning

6.1 Feature Comparison Table

Feature	Zenvara	Apache NiFi	Azure Data Factory	MuleSoft Anypoint	Apache Airflow
Codebase	~88K F#	~1.5M+ Java	Proprietary (SaaS)	~500K+ Java	~500K+ Python
Deployment	Single binary	Cluster (3+ nodes)	Cloud-only (SaaS)	Runtime + CloudHub	Cluster (scheduler + workers)
Operators/Connectors	53 built-in	300+	100+	1,000+	Community-contributed
AI-native	Yes (3 LLMs + MCP)	No	Azure OpenAI add-on	No	No
MCP server	Yes (88 tools)	No	No	No	No
Self-introspection	Yes	No	No	No	No
Expression engine	Custom (FParsec, typed)	NiFi EL	ADF expressions	DataWeave	Jinja templates
YAML-to-AST compiler	Yes	No	No	No	No
Rollback/compensation	Built into write operators	No	No	Error handlers	No
Secrets	AES-256-GCM + Vault	Sensitive props	Azure Key Vault	Vault	Connections + Vault
Auth providers	5 (Local, API Key, LDAP, OIDC, Windows)	LDAP, Kerberos, OIDC	Azure AD	LDAP, SAML, OIDC	LDAP, OAuth, RBAC
RBAC	4 roles, granular	Policies	Azure RBAC	Anypoint roles	DAG-level + role
Staging/deploy workflow	Built-in (overlay + diff)	Version control	CI/CD pipelines	Promotion APIs	Git-based
Script extensions	Python + PowerShell	Scripted processors	Custom activities	Custom policies	Python operators

Feature	Zenvara	Apache NiFi	Azure Data Factory	MuleSoft Anypoint	Apache Airflow
Visual designer	Roadmap (2.0)	Yes (flow-based)	Yes (drag-and-drop)	Yes (flow designer)	No (code-first)
Horizontal scaling	No (single-node)	Yes (cluster)	Yes (cloud-scale)	Yes (CloudHub)	Yes (Celery/K8s)
Pipeline definition	YAML (compiled)	XML (visual)	JSON (ARM/Bicep)	XML/JSON (visual)	Python (code)
State persistence	Built-in (JSON)	No	No	Object Store	XCom
Human-in-the-loop	Built-in operator	No	No	No	No
Pricing	Open-core + paid tiers	Free (ASF)	Consumption-based (\(\))	Per-connection (\($\))	Free (ASF)
JVM required	No	Yes	N/A (SaaS)	Yes	No (but Python)
Documentation-as-architecture	Yes (annotations, context)	No	No	No	No

6.2 Seven Unique Differentiators

These are capabilities that **no competitor** in the orchestration/ETL/integration space currently offers:

1. Native MCP Server (88 Tools)

Zenvara is the only orchestration platform that is also a Model Context Protocol server. AI agents (Claude, GPT, Gemini, or any MCP-compatible agent) can:

- Discover available jobs and operators
- Execute jobs and retrieve results
- Manage environments and secrets
- Read documentation and introspection data
- Deploy from staging to production

No other platform exposes itself to AI agents at this level. NiFi, ADF, MuleSoft, and Airflow all require custom API wrappers or plugins for any AI interaction.

Brand language: "*A system AI agents can reason about. Not a black box with an API — a fully legible platform.*"

2. Self-Introspection

Zenvara captures and analyzes its own MCP tool calls — recording successes, errors, patterns, and frequency. The system can answer questions about its own behavior:

- "What errors happened most often this week?"

- "Which operators are most used?"
- "What patterns does the AI agent follow?"

No competitor has this capability. Most platforms log — Zenvara *observes itself*.

Brand language: "*Introspection is not a dashboard. It's the system understanding its own patterns.*"

3. YAML-to-AST Compiler

Zenvara does not interpret YAML at runtime. It compiles YAML to an Abstract Syntax Tree (AST), validates all references, expressions, and operator metadata, and only then executes. This means:

- Schema errors caught before any step runs
- Expression syntax validated at compile time
- Unresolved references detected before execution
- Type information preserved through the compilation

No other YAML-based orchestration tool has a real compiler. NiFi interprets XML. ADF interprets JSON. Airflow runs Python. Zenvara compiles.

Brand language: "*Compilation, not interpretation. Errors caught before execution, not during.*"

4. Documentation-as-Architecture

Annotations (tags, notes, descriptions), context files (context.md), and operator metadata (metadata.yaml) are not external documentation — they are part of the system's runtime data model. Every entity carries its own knowledge. This means:

- Documentation travels with the job when exported as a package
- AI agents can read documentation alongside execution data
- Tags enable cross-entity search and organization
- Notes persist changelog, compliance info, and operational context

No competitor treats documentation as a first-class architectural concern. Most have READMEs or wikis. Zenvara has documentation that lives inside the system.

Brand language: "*Documentation is not a wiki. It's architecture.*"

5. F# Code Density

88,000 lines of F# deliver capabilities that typically require 500K-1.5M lines of Java/Python. This is not a marketing claim — it's a direct consequence of F#'s discriminated unions, pattern matching, pipeline composition, and type inference:

- The entire expression engine is ~2,000 lines (FParsec)
- The compiler pipeline is ~2,000 lines
- All 53 operators fit in ~15,000 lines across 7 extension packs

The result: faster builds, smaller binary, easier auditing, fewer bugs per feature.

Brand language: "*What takes 1.5 million lines of Java, F# does in 88,000.*"

6. Swagger Auto-Discovery

The `swagger` operator can fetch any Swagger/OpenAPI specification and automatically generate callable actions — turning any documented API into an operator without writing code.

No competitor has built-in Swagger auto-discovery. NiFi requires custom processors. MuleSoft requires connector configuration. Zenvara reads the spec and exposes actions.

Brand language: "*Point at a Swagger spec. Zenvara reads it. Now you have an operator.*"

7. Triple Interface (REST + MCP + Swagger UI)

Three complete, non-overlapping interfaces to the same system:

- **REST API**: Standard HTTP endpoints for CI/CD integration, webhooks, external systems
- **MCP server**: AI agent interface with 88 tools for autonomous operation
- **Swagger UI**: Interactive documentation and testing at `/swagger`

Each interface is complete — not a subset. Any operation available through REST is also available through MCP. This is unique in the orchestration space.

Brand language: "*REST for your CI/CD. MCP for your AI agents. Swagger for your browser. Same system.*"

6.3 Competitive Narratives

vs. Apache NiFi

> "NiFi is a powerful system — with a cluster to match. Three ZooKeeper nodes, three NiFi nodes, JVM tuning, XML-based flow definitions, and a visual designer that becomes unwieldy at scale. Zenvara is one binary. YAML definitions that version-control cleanly. An expression engine that actually parses expressions. And AI-native capabilities NiFi was never designed for. If you need to process billions of events per second, NiFi is the right tool. If you need intelligent orchestration with documentation, secrets, and AI — Zenvara is the calm alternative."

vs. Azure Data Factory

> "ADF is Azure's answer to data orchestration — cloud-only, consumption-based pricing, and locked into the Azure ecosystem. If you're all-in on Azure and cost isn't a concern, ADF works. But if you need on-premise deployment, data sovereignty, multi-cloud flexibility, or AI-native operators that aren't limited to Azure OpenAI — Zenvara runs anywhere, costs a fraction, and gives you more control."

vs. MuleSoft Anypoint

> "MuleSoft has 1,000+ connectors and a $300K/year price tag. It's the enterprise standard for API-led connectivity — and for good reason, if your problem is connecting 500 SaaS applications. But if your problem is orchestrating data transformations, running AI pipelines, and keeping documentation alongside process — you're paying enterprise prices for features you don't need. Zenvara has 53 operators that cover the most common integration patterns, plus AI operators, plus self-introspection, plus built-in secrets management — at a fraction of the cost."

vs. Apache Airflow

> "Airflow is the data engineering standard — Python-based DAGs, massive community, Kubernetes executor. If your team writes Python and needs horizontal scaling, Airflow is excellent. But Airflow DAGs are Python code — not everyone on the team can write or review them. Zenvara DAGs are YAML — readable by anyone, compilable (not interpretable), with a real expression engine instead of Jinja templates. Plus: built-in AI operators, MCP server, rollback, secrets management, and human-in-the-loop. If you want orchestration that the whole team can reason about, not just the Python developers."

---

7. Business Model

7.1 Overview

Zenvara follows an **open-core** model: a fully functional free tier for individuals and small teams, paid tiers for professional and enterprise use, with both on-premise and cloud deployment options.

The beta period is designed to build community and gather feedback before commercial launch.

7.2 Beta Program (Pre-GA)

Aspect	Detail
Duration	180 days (6 months)
License	Time-limited license key. Full features, no artificial limitations.
Expiry behavior	30-day warning period with persistent UI notification. After expiry: read-only mode (can view jobs, runs, logs — cannot execute or modify).
Telemetry	Opt-in anonymous telemetry: operator usage frequency, job count, error rates. No payload data. Clearly disclosed.
Support	Community-only (Discord/GitHub). No SLA.
Renewal	Beta can be renewed by requesting a new key (free). Purpose: maintain contact, gauge interest.
Goal	Build a community of 500+ active installations. Gather usage patterns for pricing validation.

The beta is not a trial — it's a full product with a time limit. No features are withheld. This builds trust and demonstrates confidence in the product.

7.3 Pricing Tiers (Post-GA)

Tier Structure

Tier	Target	Price	Deployment	Key Differentiators
Community	Individual developers, hobby projects	Free, forever	On-prem only	Core operators, local auth, file storage, 5 jobs, community support
Professional	Small-medium teams, production workloads	Per-node/year	On-prem	All operators, all auth providers, S3/Minio storage, unlimited jobs, email support, staging/deploy
Enterprise	Large organizations, compliance requirements	Per-node/year (volume discounts)	On-prem + cloud	Everything in Pro + LDAP/OIDC, HashiCorp Vault, priority support, SLA, dedicated onboarding

Tier	Target	Price	Deployment	Key Differentiators
Cloud	Teams wanting zero-ops	Usage-based (jobs/month + compute time)	Managed cloud	Everything in Enterprise + managed infrastructure, auto-scaling, multi-region, dashboard

Community Tier (Free)

Feature	Included
Core operators (template, log, output, noop, math, shell)	Yes
IO operators (http, sftp, filesystem, s3, ssh)	Yes
Converter operators (csv-to-json, json-extract, etc.)	Yes
Mail operators (email, imap)	Yes
Data operators (state, diff, combine)	Yes
AI operators (claude, chatgpt, gemini)	Yes
Expression engine	Yes
MCP server	Yes
Local authentication	Yes
File-based storage	Yes
Job limit	**5 active jobs**
Scheduling	**1 concurrent schedule**
MSSQL/Redshift operators	No
Integration operators (Jira, Bitbucket, SOAP, etc.)	No
LDAP/OIDC authentication	No
HashiCorp Vault	No
Staging/deployment workflow	No
Script extensions	No
Priority support	No

The Community tier is deliberately generous — enough to build real pipelines and evaluate the product. The limit is on *scale* (5 jobs, 1 schedule) and *enterprise features* (no LDAP, no Vault, no staging), not on core capabilities.

Professional Tier

Feature	Included
Everything in Community	Yes

Feature	Included
All 53 operators (including integration, data)	Yes
Script extensions (Python/PowerShell)	Yes
API Key authentication	Yes
S3/Minio storage	Yes
Staging/deployment workflow	Yes
CI/CD REST API	Yes
Package export/import	Yes
Unlimited jobs and schedules	Yes
Email support (business hours)	Yes
LDAP/OIDC authentication	No
HashiCorp Vault	No
Priority support / SLA	No

Enterprise Tier

Feature	Included
Everything in Professional	Yes
LDAP/OIDC authentication	Yes
HashiCorp Vault secrets	Yes
Windows authentication	Yes
Priority support (24-hour response)	Yes
SLA (99.9% uptime for cloud)	Yes
Dedicated onboarding session	Yes
Custom operator development support	Yes
Volume discounts (5+ nodes)	Yes

Cloud Tier

Feature	Included
Everything in Enterprise	Yes
Managed infrastructure	Yes
Auto-scaling	Yes
Multi-region deployment	Yes
Web dashboard	Yes

Feature	Included
Usage-based pricing	Yes
Zero-ops: no binary to deploy, no server to maintain	Yes

7.4 On-Prem vs. Cloud

Dimension	On-Prem	Cloud
Data sovereignty	Full control. Data never leaves your network.	Data hosted in your chosen region.
Deployment	You manage the server. Systemd/Docker/Windows Service.	We manage everything.
Pricing	Flat per-node/year. Predictable.	Usage-based (jobs/month + compute). Variable.
Updates	Manual (download new binary, restart).	Automatic rolling updates.
Scaling	Single-node (vertical scaling only).	Auto-scaling (horizontal).
Compliance	You own all compliance. No third-party data processor.	We provide compliance documentation (SOC2, GDPR DPA).
Best for	Regulated industries, DACH market, air-gapped networks.	Startups, cloud-native teams, rapid scaling.

Pricing parity principle: the on-prem Professional tier should cost roughly the same as the equivalent cloud usage for a typical workload. This avoids penalizing either choice and lets customers pick based on requirements, not cost.

7.5 Marketplace (2.0)

The Zenvara Marketplace launches with version 2.0, enabling community-contributed and verified extension packages.

Package Types

Type	Author	Quality	Price	Revenue Share
Community	Anyone	Peer-reviewed, no SLA	Free	N/A
Verified	Vetted publishers	Tested, documented, maintained	Free or Paid	70/30 (publisher/Zenvara)
Official	Zenvara team	Full SLA, enterprise-supported	Included in tier or add-on	N/A

What Can Be Published

- **Operator extensions** — new operators as DLL packages
- **Script packages** — Python/PowerShell operators with metadata
- **Job templates** — reusable job YAML with documentation
- **Environment templates** — pre-configured environment files

- **Complete solutions** — bundled job + environment + documentation for specific use cases (e.g., "Jira-to-Slack incident reporter," "S3 backup with diff detection")

Quality Gates

Community packages: basic validation (valid metadata, no malware scan failures, builds successfully).

Verified packages: code review, test coverage check, documentation review, compatibility testing against latest Zenvara version.

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8. Brand Architecture

8.1 Master Brand

Zenvara — the parent brand. All products, services, and extensions exist under this name.

The master brand is always written as "Zenvara" — capitalized first letter, no CamelCase, no abbreviation. In technical contexts (CLI, package names, URLs), lowercase `zenvara` is acceptable.

8.2 Product Sub-Brands

Sub-Brand	Full Name	Purpose	Launch
Core	Zenvara Core	The open-core runtime engine — operators, expression engine, DAG execution, MCP server	1.0 (GA)
AI	Zenvara AI	AI-native capabilities — LLM operators, MCP server, AI agent integration	1.0 (GA)
Cloud	Zenvara Cloud	Managed cloud deployment — auto-scaling, multi-region, dashboard	2.0
Marketplace	Zenvara Marketplace	Community and verified extension packages, job templates, solutions	2.0
Studio	Zenvara Studio	Web UI — visual DAG designer, job management, monitoring dashboard	2.0

Usage Rules

- In marketing: "Zenvara" is sufficient when referring to the product generally
- In technical docs: use the sub-brand when referring to a specific component (e.g., "Zenvara Cloud supports multi-region deployment")
- Never stack sub-brands: "Zenvara Cloud Marketplace" is wrong. "Zenvara Cloud" and "Zenvara Marketplace" are separate sub-brands.

8.3 Extension Pack Names

Extension packs map directly to the existing codebase structure:

Pack	Full Name	Operators	Example
Core	Zenvara Core Operators	template, log, output, noop, math, binary-decoder, shell	Available in all tiers

Pack	Full Name	Operators	Example
IO	Zenvara IO	http, sftp, filesystem, s3, ssh, archive	Available in all tiers
Converters	Zenvara Converters	csv-to-json, csv-load, csv-transform, batch-json, json-extract, md-to-pdf, xslt	Available in all tiers
Mail	Zenvara Mail	email, imap	Available in all tiers
Data	Zenvara Data	state, diff, combine, mssql, redshift	Pro and above
Integration	Zenvara Integration	jira, bitbucket, notify, signal, human-task, soap, zabbix, zabbix-sender, keepass, iis, graphql, swagger, wsdl-soap, npm	Pro and above
AI	Zenvara AI Operators	claude, chatgpt, gemini, claude-cli	Available in all tiers

8.4 Feature Naming Vocabulary

Core features use a branded vocabulary that reinforces the Zen/Vara identity:

Brand Term	Feature	Dimension	Description
Compose	DAG builder / job definition	Zen	Designing a pipeline from YAML
Resolve	Expression engine / value resolution	Zen	The system resolving `${...}` references and `${= ...}` expressions
Flow	Job execution / actor system	Zen	Data flowing through the pipeline
Observe	Self-introspection	Vara	The system capturing and analyzing its own behavior
Protect	Secrets management / rollback	Vara	Security and recoverability features
Annotate	Annotations / context / metadata	Vara	Knowledge attached to entities
Stage	Staging / deployment	Zen	The staging-to-production workflow
Extend	Script extensions / marketplace	Vara	Adding new capabilities to the platform

Usage in UI and Documentation

Instead of generic terms:

- "Create a job" → "Compose a pipeline"
- "View introspection" → "Observe the system"

- "Manage secrets" → "Protect your credentials"
- "Add documentation" → "Annotate the process"
- "Deploy to production" → "Stage and promote"
- "Write an extension" → "Extend with your code"

These are suggestions for marketing and UI language — the REST API and MCP tools should keep their technical names for clarity.

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9. Go-to-Market Strategy

9.1 Phase 1: Foundation (Months 1-3)

Objective: Establish web presence, brand identity, and initial awareness.

Domains

Action	Timeline	Priority
Register zenvara.io	Week 1	Critical
Register zenvara.ai	Week 1	Critical
Register zenvara.dev	Week 1	Defensive
Begin acquisition of zenvara.de (Squarespace parked)	Week 2-4	High
Begin acquisition of zenvara.com (Wix parked)	Month 2-3	Medium

Brand Assets

Action	Timeline
Finalize logo (geometric convergence mark)	Week 2-3
Build color palette and typography system	Week 2-3
Create brand guidelines document	Week 3-4
Design favicon and social media assets	Week 4

Web Presence

Action	Timeline
Launch landing page on zenvara.io (hero + features + waitlist)	Month 1
Set up documentation site (from existing docs)	Month 2
Create blog with first 3 posts	Month 2-3
Set up analytics (privacy-respecting: Plausible or Fathom)	Month 1

Legal

Action	Timeline
File DPMA trademark application (Germany)	Month 1
File EUIPO trademark application (EU)	Month 2
Prepare open-core license terms	Month 2-3
Draft privacy policy and terms of service	Month 2

Initial Content

Blog post series:

1. "Introducing Zenvara: Orchestration You Can Reason About" — the manifesto
2. "Why F#? Code Density in a World of Java Frameworks" — technical credibility
3. "YAML-to-AST: Why We Built a Compiler for Pipeline Definitions" — differentiation

9.2 Phase 2: Beta Launch (Months 3-6)

Objective: Get 500+ beta installations, build community, generate feedback.

Beta Launch

Action	Timeline
Release beta binary (180-day license)	Month 3
Launch beta sign-up on zenvara.io	Month 3
Distribute via GitHub Releases	Month 3
Set up telemetry dashboard (opt-in data)	Month 3
Create getting-started guide and tutorial videos	Month 3-4

Community Building

Action	Timeline
Create Discord server (or GitHub Discussions)	Month 3
Post "Show HN" on Hacker News	Month 3 (choose timing carefully)
Post on r/programming, r/dotnet, r/fsharp, r/dataengineering	Month 3-4
Submit to DevOps/integration conference CFPs (OOP, BASTA, DevOpsCon, NDC)	Month 3-4
Write guest posts for .NET and F# blogs	Month 4-5
Engage F# community (F# Foundation, F# Weekly)	Month 3 onwards

Content Pipeline

Monthly blog posts:

- Month 3: "Building AI Pipelines with Zenvara and Claude" — AI-native showcase

- Month 4: "Self-Introspecting Systems: How Zenvara Observes Itself" — unique feature
- Month 5: "From NiFi to Zenvara: A Migration Story" — competitive positioning
- Month 6: "88 MCP Tools: Making Orchestration AI-Legible" — MCP deep dive

Metrics

Metric	Target
Beta sign-ups	1,000+
Active installations (telemetry)	500+
Discord members	200+
GitHub stars	500+
Blog views (monthly)	5,000+

9.3 Phase 3: General Availability (Months 6-12)

Objective: Commercial launch with paid tiers, DACH enterprise sales, partner program.

Product Launch

Action	Timeline
Release GA 1.0 binary	Month 6
Launch pricing page with tier comparison	Month 6
Implement license key system	Month 5-6
Set up payment processing (Stripe)	Month 5-6
Publish upgrade path from beta to paid	Month 6

DACH Enterprise Sales

The DACH market (Germany, Austria, Switzerland) is the initial enterprise target due to:

- Data sovereignty requirements favor on-premise
- Strong F#/.NET presence in financial services and manufacturing
- Regulatory environment values auditable, self-documenting systems
- German engineering culture aligns with "precision" and "clarity" messaging

Action	Timeline
Attend OOP Munich (or similar DACH conference)	Month 7-8
Hire first enterprise sales rep (DACH-focused)	Month 8-9
Create German-language landing page on zenvara.de	Month 8
Build enterprise case study (from beta customer)	Month 9-10
Launch DACH partner program (IT consultancies)	Month 10-12

Partner Program

Partner Type	Benefits
Consulting Partners	Training, certification, co-marketing, deal registration
Technology Partners	Integration guides, co-developed extensions, marketplace listing
Resellers	Margin on license sales, DACH market focus initially

9.4 Phase 4: Expansion (Months 12-24)

Objective: Cloud launch, marketplace, Web UI, international growth.

Cloud (Zenvara Cloud)

Action	Timeline
Design cloud architecture (multi-tenant, regional)	Month 10-14
Build managed deployment infrastructure	Month 12-18
Launch cloud beta (invite-only)	Month 15
Launch cloud GA	Month 18-20
Add usage-based billing	Month 18

Marketplace (Zenvara Marketplace)

Action	Timeline
Design marketplace platform (packages, reviews, versioning)	Month 12-15
Define publisher program and quality gates	Month 14-16
Seed marketplace with 20 official packages	Month 16-18
Launch marketplace beta	Month 18
Enable paid packages (70/30 revenue share)	Month 20

Web UI (Zenvara Studio)

Action	Timeline
Design visual DAG builder UX	Month 12-16
Implement job management dashboard	Month 14-18
Implement real-time run monitoring	Month 16-20
Launch Studio beta	Month 20
Integrate with Cloud	Month 20-24

International Expansion

Action	Timeline
UK market: English-language content is already done	Month 12+
Nordics: leverage "Zen/Vara" Norse etymology in positioning	Month 14+
US market: tech blog presence, Product Hunt launch	Month 16+
APAC: initial presence via English content, evaluate localization	Month 20+

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10. Domain Strategy

10.1 Current Status

Domain	Status	Notes
zenvara.io	**FREE**	Available for immediate registration. NXDOMAIN confirmed.
zenvara.ai	**FREE**	Available for immediate registration. NXDOMAIN confirmed.
zenvara.de	**PARKED**	Squarespace "Coming Soon" page. No active business. Potentially purchasable.
zenvara.com	**PARKED**	Wix placeholder. No active business. Potentially purchasable.
zenvara.dev	**Not checked**	Likely available. Defensive registration recommended.

10.2 Registration Priority

Priority	Domain	Action	Timeline
P0	zenvara.io	Register immediately	Day 1
P0	zenvara.ai	Register immediately	Day 1
P1	zenvara.dev	Register as defensive	Week 1
P2	zenvara.de	Acquire (contact Squarespace registrant)	Month 1-2
P3	zenvara.com	Acquire (contact Wix registrant)	Month 2-3

10.3 Domain Usage Plan

Domain	Purpose	Content
zenvara.io	Primary product site	Main website, docs, pricing, blog
zenvara.ai	AI-focused content	AI capabilities showcase, MCP documentation, LLM operator guides. Redirects to zenvara.io/ai if separate site isn't justified.

Domain	Purpose	Content
zenvara.de	DACH market	German-language landing page, DACH case studies, pricing in EUR. Redirects to zenvara.io if German content isn't ready.
zenvara.com	Global redirect	Redirects to zenvara.io. Defensive.
zenvara.dev	Defensive	Redirects to zenvara.io. Prevents squatting.

10.4 Defensive Monitoring

Monitor (but don't register unless threatened):

- zenvara.net
- zenvara.org
- zenvara.app
- zenvara.cloud

Set up WHOIS alerts for these domains. Register reactively if any shows registration activity.

10.5 Acquisition Strategy for Parked Domains

zenvara.de (Squarespace)

The .de domain shows a Squarespace "Coming Soon" page with no active business, product, or content. This is a common pattern for speculative registrations or abandoned projects.

Approach:

1. Use WHOIS to find registrant contact information
2. Send a direct inquiry offering a reasonable purchase price
3. If no response within 30 days, use a domain broker (Sedo specializes in .de domains)
4. Budget: up to €2,000 for a parked .de domain with no active business
5. Alternative if acquisition fails: use zenvara.io as the primary site, reference .de only when it becomes available

zenvara.com (Wix)

The .com domain shows a Wix placeholder page with no active content. Similar pattern to the .de.

Approach:

1. WHOIS lookup for registrant
2. Direct inquiry
3. Domain broker if needed (GoDaddy broker service, Sedo)
4. Budget: up to $5,000 for a parked .com with no active business
5. The .com is less critical than .de — the .io TLD is well-established for tech products and is the primary domain

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11. Appendices

Appendix A: Complete Feature Inventory

Operators (53)

Core Operators (7) | Operator | YAML name | Actions | Description | |----------|----------|---------|----------| | Template | `template` | — | Handlebars-style template rendering | | Log | `log` | — | Write to job log | | Output | `output` | — | Set job output | | NoOp | `noop` | — | Pass-through (testing, placeholder) | | Math | `math` | add, subtract, multiply, divide, etc. | Arithmetic operations on values | | Binary Decoder | `binary-decoder` | — | Decode binary data formats | | Shell | `shell` | — | Execute shell commands (allowlist-restricted) |

IO Operators (6) | Operator | YAML name | Actions | Description | |----------|----------|---------|----------| | HTTP | `http` | get, post, put, patch, delete, download, upload | HTTP/HTTPS requests with OAuth, Basic, Bearer auth | | SFTP | `sftp` | download, upload, list, delete, move, exists | SFTP file operations with connection pooling | | Filesystem | `filesystem` | read, write, list, delete, copy, move, exists | Local filesystem operations | | S3 | `s3` | download, upload, list, delete, copy, move, exists | AWS S3 / MinIO object storage | | SSH | `ssh` | execute | Remote command execution via SSH | | Archive | `archive` | create, extract | ZIP/TAR archive operations |

Converter Operators (7) | Operator | YAML name | Actions | Description | |----------|----------|---------|----------| | CSV to JSON | `csv-to-json` | — | Parse CSV to JSON array | | CSV Load | `csv-load` | — | Load and parse CSV data | | CSV Transform | `csv-transform` | — | Transform CSV with column mapping | | Batch JSON | `batch-json` | — | Batch process JSON arrays | | JSON Extract | `json-extract` | — | Extract values from JSON using path expressions | | Markdown to PDF | `md-to-pdf` | — | Convert Markdown to PDF | | XSLT | `xslt` | — | XML transformation via XSLT |

Mail Operators (2) | Operator | YAML name | Actions | Description | |----------|----------|---------|----------| | Email | `email` | — | Send email via SMTP with attachments | | IMAP | `imap` | list, read, move, delete, search | Read/manage email via IMAP |

Data Operators (5) | Operator | YAML name | Actions | Description | |----------|----------|---------|----------| | State | `state` | get, set, delete, list | Persistent key-value state between runs | | Diff | `diff` | — | Compare current data against previous state | | Combine | `combine` | — | Merge multiple payloads | | MSSQL | `mssql` | query, execute, bulk-insert | Microsoft SQL Server operations | | Redshift | `redshift` | query, execute, copy, unload | Amazon Redshift operations |

Integration Operators (14+) | Operator | YAML name | Actions | Description | |----------|----------|---------|----------| | Jira | `jira` | get-issue, search, create-issue, update-issue, transition, add-comment, etc. | Atlassian Jira integration | | Bitbucket | `bitbucket` | get-repo, list-prs, create-pr, etc. | Atlassian Bitbucket integration | | Notify | `notify` | — | Send notifications (Teams, Slack, webhook) | | Signal | `signal` | — | Signal messenger integration | | Human Task | `human-task` | — | Pause pipeline for human approval | | SOAP | `soap` | — | SOAP web service calls | | Zabbix | `zabbix` | get-hosts, get-problems, get-history, etc. | Zabbix monitoring integration | | Zabbix Sender | `zabbix-sender` | — | Send metrics to Zabbix | | KeePass | `keepass` | get-entry, search, list-groups | KeePass database reading | | IIS | `iis` | — | IIS web server management | | GraphQL | `graphql` | — | GraphQL API queries | | Swagger | `swagger` | discover, execute | Auto-discover and call Swagger/OpenAPI endpoints | | WSDL/SOAP | `wsdl-soap` | discover, execute | Auto-discover and call WSDL/SOAP services | | NPM | `npm` | — | NPM package operations |

Web Search Operators (3+) | Operator | YAML name | Description | |----------|----------|----------| | DuckDuckGo | `duckduckgo` | Web search via DuckDuckGo | | Google | `google` | Web search via Google | | StackOverflow | `stackoverflow` | Search StackOverflow |

AI Operators (4) | Operator | YAML name | Actions | Description | |----------|----------|---------|----------| | Claude | `claude` | — | Anthropic Claude LLM | | ChatGPT | `chatgpt` | — | OpenAI ChatGPT LLM | | Gemini | `gemini` | — | Google Gemini LLM | | Claude CLI | `claude-cli` | — | Claude Code CLI for agentic workflows |

MCP Tools (88)

Job Management (13)

- ListJobs, GetJobDefinition, GetJobContext, SetJobContext
- CreateJob, UpdateJob, DeleteJob, ValidateJob
- ExecuteJob, ExecuteJobSync, ExecuteOperator
- TerminateJob

Run Management (5)

- ListRuns, GetRunStatus, GetRunLogs, GetRunOutput, DeleteRun

Environment Management (8)

- ListEnvironments, GetEnvironment, GetEnvironmentContext, SetEnvironmentContext
- CreateEnvironment, UpdateEnvironment, DeleteEnvironment, ValidateEnvironment
- InvalidateEnvironmentCache

Script Management (10)

- ListScripts, GetScript, CreateScript, UpdateScript, DeleteScript
- GetScriptFile, ListScriptFiles, UploadScriptFile
- GetScriptContext, SetScriptContext
- GenerateScriptTypes

Secrets Management (7)

- ListSecrets, GetSecret, GetSecretKeys, SetSecret, DeleteSecret
- GetSecretsPolicy, SetSecretsPolicy, AddSecretsPolicyRule, RemoveSecretsPolicyRule

User Management (7)

- ListUsers, CreateUser, DeleteUser
- UpdateUserPassword, UpdateUserRoles, UserExists
- ListApiKeys, CreateApiKey, RotateApiKey, DeleteApiKey

Annotations (7)

- GetAnnotation, SetAnnotation, DeleteAnnotation
- AddTag, RemoveTag, SearchAnnotations, SearchByTag, ListTags, AddNote

Operators (4)

- ListOperators, GetOperatorCategories, GetOperatorDocs, GenerateOperatorReference

System (9)

- GetContext, UpdateContext
- GetSystemLogs, GetLogStreamInfo
- ExportConfig, Deploy, StagingStatus, StagingDiff, StagingClear

- ListIntrospections, GetIntrospection, GetIntrospectionSummary, ClearIntrospections
- StopApplication, EncryptConfigValue

Guides (4)

- GetGuide, SetGuide, DeleteGuide, ListGuides

Authentication Providers (5)

Provider	Method	Storage
Local	Username/password (Argon2id)	Blob storage
API Key	X-API-Key header	Blob storage
Windows	SSPI integrated auth	Active Directory
LDAP	LDAP/AD with group-to-role mapping	LDAP server
OIDC	OpenID Connect / OAuth 2.0	External IdP

Roles and Permissions (4 roles, 11 permissions)

Permission	Admin	Developer	Operator	Viewer
Admin	X			
JobRead	X	X	X	X
JobWrite	X	X		
JobExecute	X	X	X	
RunRead	X	X	X	X
RunWrite	X	X		
RunTerminate	X		X	
EnvRead	X	X		
EnvWrite	X	X		
SystemRead	X			
UserManage	X			

Appendix B: Technical Metrics for Marketing

These metrics are verified against the actual codebase and can be used in marketing materials.

Metric	Value	Source
Production F# code	~53,500 lines	project-overview.md
Test F# code	~35,000 lines	project-overview.md
Total F# code	~88,500 lines	project-overview.md
Test-to-production ratio	~65%	project-overview.md

Metric	Value	Source
Solution projects	21	Zenvara.sln
Extension packs	7 (independent, parallel-build)	Solution structure
Test projects	8 (1 core + 7 per-extension)	Solution structure
Built-in operators	53	OperatorFactory attribute count
MCP tools	88	McpServerTool attribute count
Operator categories	7	Extension pack structure
Expression functions	16	ExpressionEvaluator.fs
Auth providers	5	Authentication.md
RBAC roles	4	Authentication.md
Secrets providers	2 (encrypted file, Vault)	Authentication.md
Target framework	.NET 10	Project files
Language	F#	Project files
Actor framework	Akka.NET	Dependencies
Parser library	FParsec	Dependencies
Web framework	Giraffe	Dependencies

Claims that are safe to make:

- "53 operators" — verified
- "88 MCP tools" — verified
- "Single binary" — true (self-contained .NET publish)
- "No JVM" — true (.NET runtime)
- "No cluster required" — true (single-node design)
- "YAML-to-AST compiler" — true (JobParser.fs, CompilerTypes.fs)
- "Type-preserving value resolution" — true (ValueParser.fs)
- "AES-256-GCM secrets" — true (encrypted file provider)
- "5 authentication providers" — true
- "Written in F#" — true
- "Actor-based execution" — true (Akka.NET)
- "Self-introspecting" — true (introspection MCP tools)
- "Built-in rollback" — true (operator metadata declares rollback)

Claims to avoid (future/aspirational, not yet shipped):

- "Visual designer" — roadmap (2.0), not shipped
- "Cloud deployment" — roadmap (2.0), not shipped
- "Marketplace" — roadmap (2.0), not shipped
- "Web UI" — roadmap (2.0), not shipped

- "Horizontal scaling" — not supported, single-node only
- "GraphQL API" — the GraphQL *operator* exists, but the API itself is REST + MCP

Appendix C: Naming Research Summary

Zenvara was selected from 830+ candidates evaluated across 12 phases:

Phase	Focus	Candidates	Key Survivors
1	Sanskrit/Norse roots	84	Solweave, Solvik, Tindra, Nirmaya
2	Modern TLAs, compounds, coined	55+	Runloom, Jobriq, Orcanova
3	Enterprise-grade coined	30+	Castix, Nextura, Synqra
4	Process-documentation alignment	20+	Praxura
5	Abstract/elegant international	60+	Tarvion, Valdris, Kalderon, Zelvara
6	Expanded coined names	40+	Norvalis, Quelara, Delvaris
7	Focused 2-syllable	36	Taldex, Gelvarn, Quelvon
8	Synthetic compounds	48	Arcvex, Castloom, Runvex
9	(continuation)	—	—
10	Human agent names	150+	Nelrik, Jarlen, Tarvio
11	English compounds + "42"	120+	craft42, graph42, opslace
12	AI-embedded + premium 42	50+	axiom42, resolve42, harbor42

Top pick (existing asset): Konklamo — .de and .com already owned, .io and .ai free.

Top pick (coined, all free): Tarvion — all 4 domains free, zero conflicts.

Selected for branding (purchasable, strongest aesthetics): **Zenvara** — "Zen" + "vara" (clarity + truth). .io and .ai free. .de and .com are parked (no active businesses), purchasable.

Why Zenvara over Konklamo or Tarvion: Zenvara has the strongest phonetic beauty, the deepest etymological alignment with the product's duality (execution + knowledge), and the most immediate international recognition ("Zen" is universally understood). The domain situation is manageable — .io and .ai are free for immediate registration, .de and .com are acquisitions, not competitions.

Full naming research: `docs/TAS-96_naming-research.md`

Appendix D: Brand Glossary

Term	Definition	Usage
Zenvara	The product name. "Zen" (clarity, flow) + "Vara" (truth, protection).	Always capitalized. Never abbreviated.
Compose	Creating a pipeline from YAML.	"Compose a pipeline with 4 steps."
Resolve	The expression engine evaluating `${...}` references.	"Values resolve at compile time."

Term	Definition	Usage
Flow	Data moving through the DAG. Actor-based execution.	"The pipeline flows through 3 operators."
Observe	Self-introspection. The system analyzing its own behavior.	"Observe the system's MCP tool patterns."
Protect	Secrets management, rollback, access control.	"Protect credentials with AES-256-GCM."
Annotate	Adding tags, notes, context to entities.	"Annotate the job with compliance notes."
Stage	The staging-to-production workflow.	"Stage the changes. Review the diff. Deploy."
Extend	Adding operators via scripts or extensions.	"Extend the platform with a Python operator."
Calm	The brand's signature adjective. Not "powerful" or "robust" — calm.	"One calm system."
Operator	A unit of work in a pipeline step.	"The http operator fetches data."
Pipeline	A sequence of operators defined in YAML.	"This pipeline has 5 steps."
Run	A single execution of a pipeline.	"Run #01J1K2... completed in 3.2s."
Payload	The data flowing between operators.	"The payload accumulates as steps complete."

Document Metadata

Field	Value
Created	2026-02-28
Author	TAS-96 naming and branding research
Status	Draft — pending brand decision
Source files	CLAUDE.md, project-overview.md, TAS-96_naming-research.md, authentication.md
Codebase version	master branch, commit 83d8db5